column that excerpts an article or editorial from the archives of the *Economic Weekly*; the second, a paragraph that appears every week under the masthead and reads: ‘Ever since the first issue in 1966, *EPW* has been India’s premier journal for comment on current affairs and research in the social sciences. It succeeded *Economic Weekly* (1949–1965) which was launched and shepherded by SACHIN CHAUDHURI, who was also the founder–editor of *EPW*. As editor for thirty-five years (1969–2004), KRISHNA RAJ gave *EPW* the reputation it now enjoys.’

To me, Krishna Raj was both friend and mentor; but in the two decades (and more) of our association, there were two extended periods when we were not in communication. For, in 1991, and again in 1999, I fought with the journal on matters which I thought were of high principle but others would think were of mere ideology. Much later, Krishna Raj was kind enough to write to me that ‘the fights, as you called them, were very good for the *EPW*’. But it is noteworthy that each time it was I who sued for peace. The *EPW* could do without me; I could not do without the *EPW*.